

NAME: STREAM:

112/1
English Language
August, 2025
2 Hours

MBOGO HIGH SCHOOL
Uganda Certificate of Education
END OF TERM II ASSESSMENT 2025
S.1 ENGLISH LANGUAGE
2 Hours

INSTRUCTIONS:

- This paper consists of **two** sections: **A** and **B**. It has **four** examination items.
- Section **A** is **compulsory**. Answer **one** item from Section **B**.
- Answer **three** examination items in all. Answers **must** be written in the spaces provided.
- Any additional items answered will **not** be scored.

For Examiner's Use only		
Section	Score	Examiner's Initials
A		
B		
Total		

SECTION A

Item 1. *Over the years, the government of Uganda has constructed a number of markets in several major towns. Your English language class recently visited one of these markets and realised that they face a number of challenges. After the visit, you came across the newspaper article below. Using the information in it, explain to your class the problems of Wandegeya market. (Use about 100 words.)*

The market that was replaced by the current modern Wandegeya market was known as Sabasajja's market. Traders who were in the old market were in 2011 relocated to pave way for redevelopment of the new one which sits on 1.2 acres of land. Traders who were in the old market were given priority in the new one but they sold their stalls to new traders. These new traders failed to attract new customers to their new stalls yet the old traders had loyal customers. The 22billion market, whose construction started in 2012 was officially commissioned by President Yoweri Museveni in 2014. Business starts at 5:30am and closes at 9:00pm.

Another group of traders relocated to Wandegeya market from Busega to pave way for the construction of another market in Busega. These traders say most of their merchandise is rotting away because of lack of customers. They say they do not understand why the market has failed to pick up; "We do not understand why people do not come to this market. Either people do not know that this is a market or our leaders have failed to advertise," laments one of the traders. She observes that what she earns from selling fish in the market is not enough to sustain her family.

Traders dealing in fresh foods such as tomatoes, avocados, onions, cabbage and other vegetables are also crying. They say they have been neglected by Kampala Capital City Authority (KCCA) which is in charge of the market. They say since the market was opened in 2014, KCCA has hardly responded to their pleas. The traders who have stalls at the back of the market say it floods whenever it rains, they add that even when the sun shines, it hits their products hence spoiling them.

Some other traders complain that accessing some sections of the Wandegeya market is difficult because it was constructed in a manner which is not friendly. Customers are expected to climb to the second and third floor of the market to purchase the merchandise. This is where some of the stalls are found. The steps are

so steep. This means that customers cannot do any form of window shopping. One of the market administrators admits that the public does not know that Wandegeya market has all the items such as clothes, shoes, fresh food stuff, beef to mention but a few. He admits that there is need for massive advertising. “The traders lack customers and this is greatly affecting their business,” he observes. He, however, says, due to the constraints, KCCA was forced to reduce the charges on stalls by 40% by the beginning of this year. Rent for tomato vendors’ stalls was reduced from shs250,000 to shs120,000. Although there are 1,114 vendors out of the expected 1,200, the traders say the number is less than what the management states.

The traders explain that they still face challenges of paying rent despite reducing it. The traders say they have resorted to moving their products outside the market in the evening to join the street vendors. The traders also say that although the market is a permanent structure, cases of theft were becoming rampant which forced the market leadership to hire private security guards who patrol the market. The traders complain that Wandegeya market has suffered at the hands of leaders who want to make political capital out of the traders’ situation, especially during election time.

“Politicians have played a negative role in misguiding our traders,” one of the leaders emphasizes. The traders also find power bills well above them. However, usually KCCA comes in to clear the trader’s electricity bills. The traders also complain about garbage. Garbage accumulates and no one seems to care. It is the duty of traders to find a way of clearing the garbage, yet traders are not making any realistic profits. *(Adopted from; New Vision of Thursday, April 2017.)*

Rough Copy

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Fair Copy

Item 2. *Read the text below.*

Tackling Kampala's noise, air pollution

Just the other day on Jinja Road, I had my daily dose of trauma – the blaring sirens of VIPs' vehicles, bodabodas buzzing like bees (and the wrong side of the road) – all amidst the typical Kampala jam (which many of us are probably used to). As I lowered my car window for some fresh air, a strange stench smacked me in the face. It was the '*kasasiro*' truck, hauling open waste and boldly attempting to create a third lane on a road meant just for two. Imagine the stress of rush-hour traffic, garnished with a bouquet of disruptive noise, some dust, a tinge of petrol fumes and the occasional smoke from domestic and biomass burning.

A recent report by the National Environment Management Authority (NEMA) revealed that Kampala's air pollution levels exceed the World Health Organisation's (WHO) recommended limits by more than eight times. At this rate, Kampala residents have two choices: invest in an industrial-grade air purifier or develop superhuman nostrils to filter out particulate matter (both are possible in this AI era). The government's efforts to combat dirty air are as visible as clear sky in Kampala. With an industrial area just a few metres from the CBD, maybe we should start wearing gas masks as accessories to tackle the emissions.

If the air doesn't kill you, the noise just might. Imagine it's 2:00a.m, and the usual infuriating noise from human and motor traffic has finally died down. You are deep in dreamland, maybe dreaming of a quiet vacation at Kabalega National Game Park, when suddenly – BANG! '*Yesu ni wangu wa uzima wa milele!*' blasts from the trans-night prayers at a nearby worship place. Or at 5:00a.m, a loud speaker shouts, 'Allahu Akbar!' – and the neighbourhood springs to sudden life. Sure, the Lord must be praised, but does it have to be at decibel levels that rival a jet engine? In Uganda, noise pollution from places of worship – especially during night vigils – has become a part of life. Churches, mosques and preachers with megaphones have turned serene nights into all-night concerts. Clubs and bars without soundproofing only add to the chaos. It is hard to distinguish residential areas from commercial zones.

NEMA's regulations on noise pollution are as effective as a whisper in a nightclub. The Noise Standards and Control Regulations, 2003, which supposedly govern acceptable noise levels, seem more honoured in the breach than in the observance. But does anyone even know that these regulations exist? Enforcement

officers, perhaps weary from their own sleepless nights, often turn a blind ear to all these infractions.

Enough on noise pollution: let us get back to the bad air problem. Bad air quality in Kampala is a problem that can't be ignored because bad air kills. It is high time we tackled air pollution with the fervour of a crusader at a revival meeting. Implementing strict emissions standards, encouraging public transportation, and investing in green spaces could transform our choking cityscape. Kudos to KCCA Chief, Dorothy Kisaka and her team – I see and feel where she's taking us – Kampala, the smart green city. Clean air isn't just a right – it's a necessity for a healthy life.

As for the noise, let's just turn down the volume. Places of worship need to respect peace and quiet, especially at night. Yes, prayer is powerful, but so is a good night's sleep. The Almighty will hear you just fine without a PA system that could wake the dead. We need stricter enforcement of noise regulations and soundproofing for our nocturnal noisemakers. Just like some airports are pioneering 'silent airports' as a way of creating more peaceful environment for passengers, we can launch our own trend: a 'silent city' for the well-being of the Kampala residents!

Uganda deserves better air and quieter nights. We have the policies. We owe it to ourselves to push for their implementation to clear the air and hush the unnecessary clamour. There shouldn't be any cheap politics about this. Cleaner air and quieter nights aren't just lofty goals – they're simple and achievable realities if we act now. So, here's to a Kampala where we can inhale without coughing and sleep without earplugs. It's not just a dream – it's a right.

[Adapted from New Vision, Friday, May 24, 2024 by Crispin Kaheru]

Tasks:

- a) The passage helps us understand the true nature of the people we live with such as preachers, law enforcement officers and the VIPs. Describe the character of the religious people as presented in the passage.

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- b) You have just read this passage and remembered that one of your friends lives in Kampala. What should your friend do to minimise their exposure to air pollution?

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- c) The writer suggests that noise pollution from places of worship is a significant problem in Kampala. Explain what, according to the passage, should be done to solve the problem of pollution in Kampala.

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- d) The writer emotionally describes the pollution in Kampala. Explain how he feels about the issue of noise pollution in Kampala.

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- e) Explain what the writer means by the phrase, “*the blaring sirens*” as used in the passage.

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- f) *Kampala’s air pollution levels exceed the WHO recommended limits by more than eight times.* (Re-write the sentence ***without the word “exceed” and use the comparative.***)

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SECTION B

Either

Item 3.

Your school is set to hold a Grand Inter-classes Debate competitions on the resolution: ***Child Labour is a Violation of Children's Rights***. You have been selected to represent your class. With the help of your classmates and the other selected debaters, you have researched and come up with three important views that you will present as the first speaker.

Write the speech you will deliver in order to give your class a chance to win this debate. (Use **200 – 300** words)

Or

Item 4.

You are the Health and Sanitation Prefect at your school. You have recently found out that there has been a lot of pollution as a result of poor waste disposal habits, among other factors. This has caused poor-hygiene-related diseases such as diarrhea, cholera and urinary infections among the students.

Write and inform the Head teacher about this problem and suggest possible solutions. (Use **200 – 300** words)

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